

PRINCIPAL ENTERPRISE ARCHITECT REFERENCE SERIES

VOLUME 8 OF 8

Implementation Accelerator Kit

Ready-to-adapt templates: ARB charter, Terms of Reference, RACI matrices, review forms, executive dashboards, Policy-as-Code starters, and a phased enterprise rollout roadmap.

Enterprise Architecture Review Board Handbook · Banking & Financial Services Edition

Part A — Foundational Templates

This final volume converts everything in Volumes 1-7 into directly usable starting templates. None of these should be adopted verbatim without adapting to your specific institution's regulatory environment, scale, and existing governance landscape (Volume 1) — but each is structured to need editing, not building from a blank page.

15.1 ARB Charter Template

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ARCHITECTURE REVIEW BOARD CHARTER

1. PURPOSE
The ARB exists to ensure architecturally significant technology
decisions align with enterprise standards, manage technical and
regulatory risk, and protect long-term technology sustainability,
while enabling business delivery velocity.

2. SCOPE
In scope: [define threshold - e.g., initiatives exceeding $X budget,
touching customer data, introducing new technology not on the
approved standards list, or spanning multiple business domains]
Out of scope: [define explicitly - e.g., routine changes following
established golden paths, changes below defined risk/cost threshold]

3. AUTHORITY
The ARB has authority to: approve, conditionally approve, reject,
or request revision of in-scope architecture proposals.
The ARB does NOT have authority to: override Risk Committee risk
appetite decisions, approve budget (Executive Steering Committee
retains budget authority), or set enterprise technology standards
unilaterally (Technology Standards Board retains that authority).

4. MEMBERSHIP
Chair: [Chief Architect / nominated lead]
Standing members: [list roles, not just names, for continuity]
Delegate authorities: [CISO delegate veto on security-critical
items per Volume 1, Section 1.3]

5. DECISION-MAKING
Quorum: [define]
Decision method: [consensus-seeking with chair tie-break authority
is the most common pattern; document the actual method used]
Escalation: per the escalation matrix in Volume 1, Section 1.3

6. CADENCE
[Define standing meeting cadence and the fast-track/exception
process for time-sensitive reviews]

7. REVIEW & SUNSET
This charter will be reviewed annually and is subject to amendment
by [governing authority - typically CTO Council].
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15.2 Terms of Reference (ToR) — Key Sections Beyond the Charter

Section	Content
Roles & Responsibilities	Detailed RACI for ARB members, secretariat, and submitting architects (see 15.3)
Submission Requirements	Reference to the artifact catalog (Volume 4) — which artifacts are mandatory vs. optional by review tier
Review Tiers	Define at least two tiers (e.g., Standard and Expedited/Fast-Track) with different artifact and cadence requirements based on risk/complexity
Conflict of Interest Policy	How ARB members recuse themselves from reviewing initiatives they're directly delivering
Appeals Process	How a rejected proposal can be reconsidered (Volume 1, Section 1.3)

15.3 RACI Matrix Template — ARB Operating Roles

Activity	Accountable	Responsible	Consulted	Informed
Submit architecture proposal	Submitting Architect	Submitting Architect	Domain SMEs	Business sponsor
Pre-screen submission for completeness	ARB Secretariat	ARB Secretariat (or autonomous agent, Volume 7)	—	Submitting Architect
Conduct review	ARB Chair	ARB members	Security, Data Governance, FinOps as relevant	Submitting team
Render decision	ARB Chair	ARB (collective)	—	All stakeholders
Track conditional approval follow-ups	ARB Secretariat	Submitting Architect	—	ARB Chair
Maintain pattern catalog / reference architectures	Chief Architect	Architecture CoP	ARB members	All architects
Report risk register to Risk Committee	ARB Chair	ARB Secretariat	Risk function	Risk Committee

15.4 Risk Register Template

Field	Description
Risk ID	Unique identifier, linked in the knowledge graph (Volume 3)
Description	Clear statement of the risk, not the symptom
Likelihood / Impact	Scored against the institution's standard risk taxonomy
Risk Owner	Named individual, not a team — accountability requires a person
Mitigation Plan	Specific actions with dates, not aspirational statements
Residual Risk	Risk level after mitigation, explicitly stated and accepted by an appropriately senior owner if non-trivial
Review Date	Next scheduled reassessment
Escalation Status	Whether this has been escalated to Risk Committee per Volume 1, Section 1.3

15.5 Architecture Review Submission Form (Condensed)

SECTION 1: BUSINESS CONTEXT

- Business capability(ies) affected (Vol 3, Part B reference)
- Business sponsor and engagement confirmation
- Cost of delay if not approved this cycle (Vol 2, Section 3.3)

SECTION 2: ARCHITECTURE SUMMARY

- Context + container diagrams (Vol 4, Section 7.2)
- Pattern(s) used and rationale (Vol 3, Section 5.5)
- Quality attributes explicitly prioritized / deprioritized (Vol 4, Part B)

SECTION 3: RISK & COMPLIANCE

- Completed Compliance Matrix (Vol 4, Section 7.3)
- Threat model summary (security-critical items only)
- Data classification and lineage summary

SECTION 4: AI-SPECIFIC (if applicable)

- Agent Specification / Memory Policy / MCP Tool Contracts (Vol 4, Section 7.5)
- AI Governance Board / Model Risk / Responsible AI Council review status (Vol 1, Section 1.2)

SECTION 5: ECONOMICS

- Cost projection at current and 3x scale (Vol 2, Part A)
- Build vs. buy rationale if applicable

SECTION 6: OPERATIONAL READINESS

- Support Model status (Vol 4, Section 7.6)
- Runbook coverage for critical failure scenarios

Part B — Dashboards, Automation Starters & Rollout Roadmap

15.6 Executive Dashboard — Recommended Metrics

Metric	Audience	Refresh Cadence
Review queue depth and cycle time	CTO Council, ARB Chair	Weekly
% initiatives passing first review without rework	ARB Chair	Monthly
Open architecture exceptions (count, age, severity)	Risk Committee, CTO Council	Monthly
Technical debt valuation trend (Vol 2, Section 3.1)	Executive Steering Committee	Quarterly
Capability redundancy index (Vol 3, Section 6.3)	Executive Steering Committee	Quarterly
AI governance gate completion rate	AI Governance Board, Risk Committee	Monthly
Architecture conformance drift (fitness function pass rate)	ARB Chair, Platform Engineering Council	Continuous/weekly rollup

15.7 KPI & OKR Starter Set for an Architecture Function

SAMPLE OKR — ILLUSTRATIVE, NOT PRESCRIPTIVE

Objective: Reduce architecture governance latency without compromising risk coverage

KR1: Reduce median review cycle time from X weeks to Y weeks

KR2: Increase % of routine decisions handled via automated fitness functions (Vol 2, Section 4.4) from X% to Y%

KR3: Maintain zero unmitigated critical findings escalated from Internal Audit related to architecture governance gaps

KR4: Achieve 100% Retirement Checklist completion for decommissioned systems (closing the most commonly skipped artifact, Vol 4 Section 7.6)

15.8 Maturity Assessment Questionnaire (Condensed)

Level	Characteristics
1	Ad hoc reviews, no consistent artifact requirements, no audit trail, governance exists informally or not at all
2	Defined ARB charter exists, basic artifact requirements, but review queue is a bottleneck and documentation decays quickly post-approval
3	Federated or hybrid operating model functioning, scorecards in use, knowledge management actively maintained, capability map exists and is current
4	Architecture economics and decision science formally applied, fitness functions automate routine governance, AI Governance Board integration mature
5	AI-native governance patterns (Volume 7) in production for appropriate decision classes, continuous architecture validation, self-sustaining knowledge graph, demonstrable regulatory examination readiness on demand

15.9 Policy-as-Code Starter Library — Pattern Index

Policy Category	Representative Rule
Network segmentation	No direct internet egress from services classified as handling payment card data
Encryption enforcement	All data stores classified Confidential or above must have encryption-at-rest enabled, verified continuously
Dependency hygiene	No production deployment with a critical-severity unpatched vulnerability older than defined SLA
Cross-domain access	No direct cross-domain database access (Volume 7, Section 13.3 worked example)
AI tool permission scoping	No AI agent tool grants write access to financial ledger systems without an explicit, separately-reviewed Agent Specification
Cost governance	Alert when any single resource's cost trend exceeds defined month-over-month growth threshold

15.10 Enterprise Rollout Roadmap (Phased)

Phase	Duration (typical)	Focus
Phase 1 — Foundation	0-3 months	Charter and ToR ratified; artifact catalog and scorecards adapted to institution; initial knowledge graph schema stood up
Phase 2 — Operating Rhythm	3-9 months	ARB cadence established; review queue metrics baselined; capability map built for highest-value domains first (Volume 3, Section 6.4)
Phase 3 — Economic & Decision Rigor	9-18 months	Architecture economics (Volume 2) formally integrated into submission requirements; ATAM/CBAM adopted for high-stakes decisions
Phase 4 — Automation	18-30 months	Fitness functions and policy-as-code deployed for routine governance; AI-assisted review (Volume 7, early patterns) introduced
Phase 5 — AI-Native Maturity	30+ months	Continuous validation, knowledge-graph-backed reasoning, and selectively-scoped autonomous review agents in production, with audit trails mature enough for regulatory examination on demand

A CLOSING CAUTION ON THE ROADMAP

This phasing is illustrative and should be compressed or extended based on your institution's starting maturity and risk appetite — a bank already running a mature Federated model with strong tooling might reasonably compress Phases 1-3 significantly. Resist the temptation to skip Phase 2's operating-rhythm discipline in pursuit of Phase 4's automation; automating an undisciplined governance process just produces undisciplined governance faster.

15.11 Change Management & Communication Strategy — Core Principles

- **Lead with the relief, not the rules.** Architects and delivery teams adopt new governance faster when it's framed as reducing their own risk exposure and rework (clearer expectations, fewer late-stage surprises) rather than as new compliance burden.
- **Pilot with a friendly, high-visibility initiative first.** A successful, well-publicized first pass through the new model builds more buy-in than any amount of charter documentation.
- **Make the artifact catalog self-service before mandating it.** Templates, examples, and a clear "why this artifact matters" rationale (Volume 4) reduce resistance far more than a mandate alone.

15.12 Training Curriculum & Certification Path — Suggested Structure

Track	Content
Foundation (all architects)	Governance ecosystem map (Volume 1), artifact catalog (Volume 4), submission process
Practitioner (active ARB submitters)	Decision science frameworks (Volume 2, Part B), quality attribute fluency (Volume 4, Part B)
Principal track	Architecture economics (Volume 2, Part A), industry/regulatory deep dive (Volume 6), case study analysis (Volume 7, Part B)
ARB leadership	Escalation and conflict resolution (Volume 1), scorecard design discipline (Volume 5), AI-native governance roadmap ownership (Volume 7, Part A)

15.13 Continuous Improvement Framework

Close the loop the same way Volume 2's benefits realization discipline demands of the initiatives the ARB reviews: the ARB itself should be subject to its own version of benefits realization tracking. A quarterly retrospective against the executive dashboard metrics (15.6), explicitly asking what governance friction was avoidable versus genuinely necessary, is the mechanism that prevents this entire handbook's recommendations from calcifying into the same kind of unexamined, stale process this handbook was written to help you avoid inheriting.

Closing Note — Using This Handbook in Your Career

This eight-volume set is deliberately broad rather than narrow, because Principal-level architecture judgment is, in large part, the ability to recognize which volume's lens applies to the situation in front of you — when a problem is fundamentally a governance-mesh ownership question (Volume 1), an unstated economic trade-off (Volume 2), a knowledge-management failure dressed up as something else (Volume 3), or a missing artifact that would have made an entire dispute unnecessary (Volume 4). The questions and scorecards in Volume 5 give you a starting vocabulary; the banking deep-dive in Volume 6 gives you the regulatory fluency that distinguishes a Principal Architect from a strong solution architect; the AI-native material in Volume 7 gives you the forward edge increasingly expected of senior architecture leadership; and the accelerator kit in this volume gives

you something to actually stand up, not just discuss.

Treat this handbook as a living reference, not a one-time read — the same discipline it recommends for architecture knowledge management in Volume 3 applies to your own use of it. Revisit volumes as you encounter the situations they describe; the material will mean considerably more after you've sat through a contested ARB escalation or a board-level risk reporting cycle than it does on first read.